

Communication in Business

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Executive Summary

Word Count:

Task 01 = 1050

Task 02 = 1100

Table of Content

Task 01 - Communication in Analysis of Dialog Axiata PLC

01.1 Introduction

In the dynamic and competitive telecommunications industry, communication is a basic principle of business success. In this report, it will discuss the communication processes that influence the performance of the business by taking Dialog Axiata PLC, which is a leading Sri Lankan telecommunications company (Khadija & Omar, 2023). The report will compare two dominating communication models, the Shannon-Weaver Model of Communication and the Berlo SMCR Model of Communication, and explain why rigorous communication is important for Dialog. Then this report will evaluate the essential aspects of communication (sender, message, medium, receiver, feedback, noise) in relation to the work of the organization, paying particular attention to internal and external communication processes.

01.2 Comparison of Communication Models

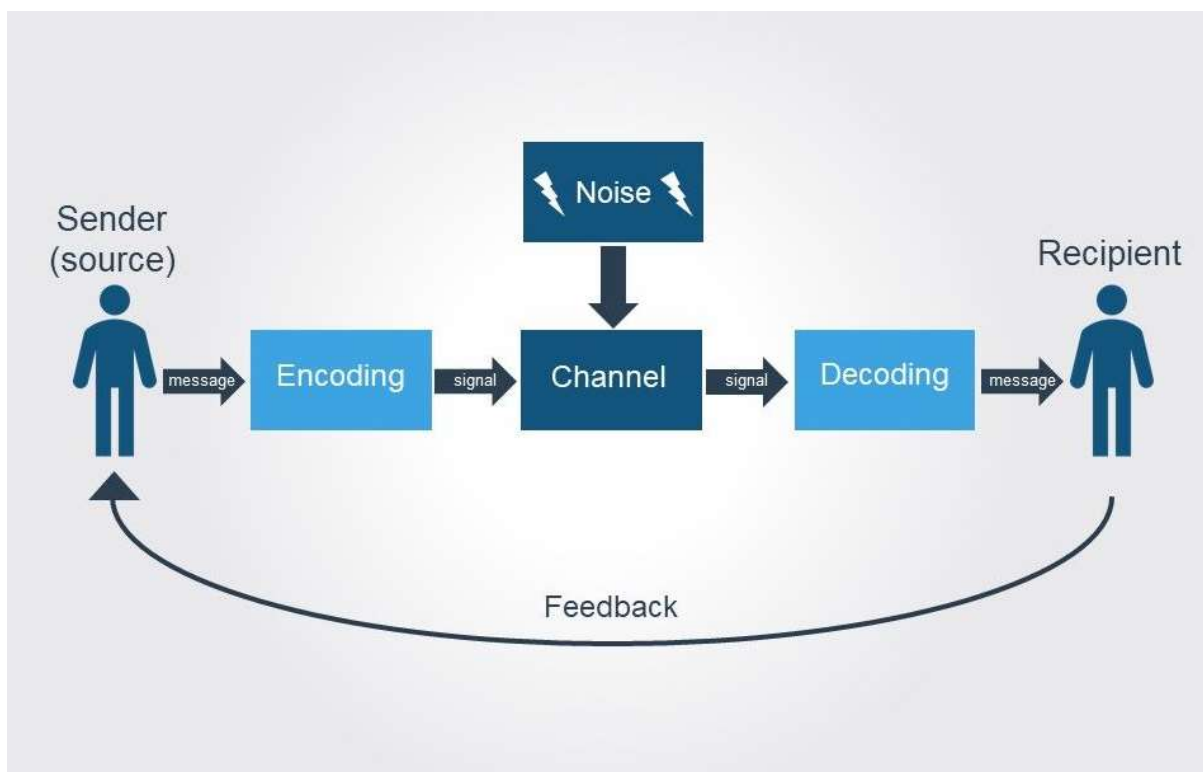


Figure 1: Shannon - Weaver Model

The Shannon-Weaver Model of Communication, which was originally developed by Claude Shannon and Warren Weaver, defines communication as a linear process that involves a source transmitting a message to a recipient through a transmitter that transmits the message over a channel to a receiver; noise is a potential problem along the way. The model focuses on the

technical components of message transmission and highlights three levels of problem which are technical (can the signal be transmitted?), semantic (does the meaning get through?), and effectiveness (does the intended effect take place?). This popular model is, however, criticized for being one-way direction and feedback-free (Getchell, et al., 2023).

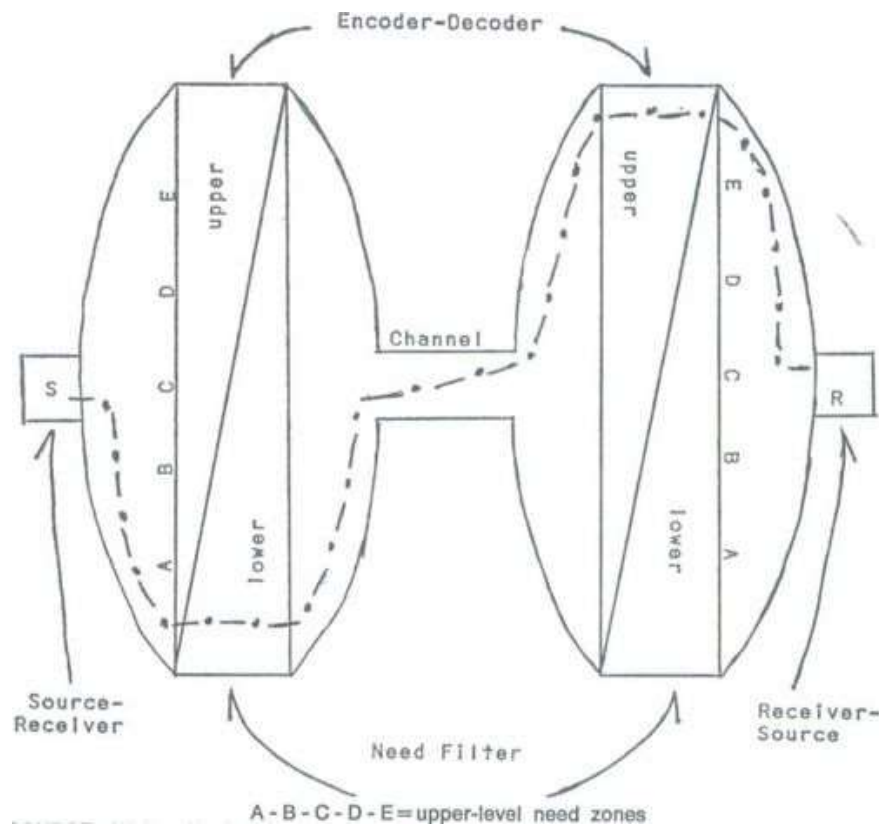


Figure 2: Berlo's SMCR

In contrast, Berlo's SMCR model (Source-Messenger-Channel-Receiver) extends the linear model with factors in each of its elements: e.g., the sender's communication skills, attitude, knowledge, social systems and culture; the message's content, elements, treatment, codes, structure; the channel's senses; and the receiver's counterparts. Importantly, Berlo recognizes that effective communication is only possible where sender and receiver are aligned along these dimensions, and complicates such an interaction with concepts like encoding/decoding, noise and differential fields of experience. (Janse, 2024)

Using these in the context of Dialog Axiata, the Shannon-Weaver model is helpful as a high-level conceptual model to map the flow of a corporate message (for example, a corporate

communications bulletin to regional managers). However, these limitations are exposed in a complex organization: feedback and two-way flows are extremely important. Berlo SMCR model is more adaptable in handling the human, cultural and organizational factors that affect the communication in a large telecommunication company in Sri Lanka. Thus, while both models are useful, Berlo's model is more sensitive for business and organizational communication.

01.3 The Importance of Effective Communication Dialog Axiata

Effective communication is essential to business organizations on various circumstances: it can facilitate coordination of actions, promote decision making, improve stakeholder relationships, guarantee that strategic objectives are understood throughout the organization and reduce misunderstandings and conflicts (Leonard, et al., 2004).

At Dialog Axiata, based in Colombo and having multiple service lines of mobile, broadband, digital television and financial services, effective communication is especially important. The company's annual report for 2024 says, "Our people have been the driving force behind our resilience... The essential role Dialog plays in supporting our customers, businesses, communities and the nation at large." In such a large and diversified organization, there are chances of breakdown in communication pattern which can result in service disruption, reputational damage, regulatory risk and disengagement of employees (Dialog, 2024). Moreover, Dialog's telecommunication industry is dynamic, highly regulated, and where innovation from a customer centric perspective is of utmost importance; internal and external communications of changes, new services, and network developments are of strategic importance.

Thus, good communication in Dialog supports:

- **Internal coordination:** alignment of cross-functional teams (network operations / customer service / sales / finance)
- **External stakeholders' management:** regulators, customers, media, investors, communities
- **Crisis management:** e.g., in the event of nationwide outages, network upgrades or socio-economic disruptions (Sri Lanka has experienced massive challenges over the last few years)

- **Culture and change management:** Dialog's drive for innovation (e.g., pioneering the 5G pilot transmission) requires effective vision, training, feedback and adaptation.

01.4 Elements of Communication in the Context of Dialog Axiata

Sender: In the context of Dialog, senders could be senior leadership (Chairman's message in annual report), departmental managers, team leads, and external communications teams. The success of the sender depends on his/her communication ability, credibility, cultural sensitivity (Sri Lanka is multi-lingual and multi-ethnic), and correspondence to corporate values (e.g. "service from the heart").

Message: The message could be of many different forms-announcements of corporate strategies, employee messages, promotion of new services, message to customers, regulatory filings, etc. At Dialog, the message needs to be structured clearly (i.e. simple English and Sinhala / Tamil wherever appropriate), coded appropriately (technical vs layman terms) and packaged (treatment) to fit the medium and receiver.

Medium (Channel): Dialog has multiple channels: Written communications (intranets, emails, memos), face-to-face meetings, team huddles, newsletters; Outside channels (press releases, social media, customer SMS alerts, website). Selection of channel affects immediacy, reach, cost and feedback capability.

Receiver: Receivers could be internal (executives and field technicians) or external (customers, regulators, shareholders, community members). Each group of receivers has differently levels of expertise, expectation, level of language, cultural background and motivations. For effective communication, the sender must consider these differences (as per Berlo's model - knowledge, attitude, social system).

Feedback: Unlike purely linear models, effective communication at Dialog must include feedback loops - employee surveys, team discussions, customer complaints, social media reactions, performance metrics (service uptake, churn). Feedback enables the sender to adjust message, channel, treatment and rectify misunderstandings or noise.

Noise: There are many types of noise that can interfere. In Dialog's case: technical noise (poor network during message dissemination, system outages), semantic noise (jargon not understood by frontline staff or customers), cultural noise (multilingual Sri Lanka, differences

in field experience), organizational noise (hierarchical barriers, information bottlenecks) and external noise (media misinterpretation, regulatory changes, socio-economic turmoil). Reducing noise is critical in order for the message to be delivered as intended.

(Gunasekara, 2015)

For an example: When dialog is completing a major network upgrade, the sender (network operations director) sends a message (upgrade schedule and customer impact) through a channel (company email and SMS) to receivers (customers and internal staff). Feedback may include Customer queries, front line reports. Noise could happen to customers who may not understand or receive the message after the upgrade start date because of a glitch in the data system, resulting in confusion and reputational risk.

01.5 Conclusion

Business communication is not easy and is quite a task especially in a complex organization like Dialog Axiata PLC. The Shannon-Weaver model provides a basic understanding of the flow of communication, but the Berlo SMCR model provides deeper understanding of how human, cultural and organizational factors affect the flow of communication. Dialog - The ability to communicate is a strategic enabler which delivers on strategic goals, enables operational synchronization, facilitates engagement and builds resilience in a volatile business environment. It will suggest that the aspects of communication: sender, message, medium, receiver, feedback, noise, etc. if properly applied to situation of the organization in Sri Lanka context will lead to better business performance and decrease the risk.

Task 02 - Internal and External Communication Practices at Dialog Axiata PLC

02.1 Introduction

The final assessment concerned the need for efficient communication as a pillar of business success, and how Dialogue Axiata PLC applies very systematic communication theories, such as Shannon-Weaver and Berlo SMCR models, i.e. to facilitate the circulation of information and the knowledge of stakeholders. These models were employed to demonstrate that corporate communication is not only a process of sharing messages but a strategy that contains encoding, transmission, feedback, and noise minimization and alignment.

Based on these theoretical implications, this report critically evaluates Dialogue Axiata's internal and external communication strategies to its key stakeholders, including employees, management, customers, and regulatory bodies. It also aims to determine the internal and external obstacles that may threaten communication efficiency and suggest approaches that may be adopted to defeat them. This research is based upon concepts of the aforementioned communication models because it intends to specify how theory can be applied to practice in the dynamic organizational and technological environment.

02.2 Internal Communication at Dialog Axiata PLC

Dialogue Axiata PLC employs formal and informal communication channels in its internal communication process to ensure that the operations are efficient and the employees are engaged. Formal channels refer to the company intranet, human resource bulletins, internal newsletters, performance reports, and policy updates, which are formal ways of official information flow issued by the management to the employees. Through such channels, transparency and adherence to corporate processes are possible (Al-Ahmad, 2021). On the contrary, informal communication through team meetings, Microsoft Teams, WhatsApp groups, employee suggestion portals, and others encourages open communication and real-time interactions. It improves relationships in the workplace and innovation (Muyanga & Phiri, 2021).

The communication in Dialog runs in three key directions, including vertically (top-down management briefings, employee feedback loops), horizontally (between the marketing and customer care units); and diagonally (between the technical and administrative teams). Such a multidirectional method conforms to the SMCR model of Berlo, according to which the abilities and knowledge of a sender and their attitude shape the clarity and perception of the

messages (Luo et al., 2022). The feedback mechanisms in place, like employee engagement surveys and performance reviews, will result in constant enhancement of message interpretation and comprehension within the multicultural workforce of the organization.

As a case in point, when implementing the 5G, Dialog's engineering and marketing departments held weekly cross-departmental gatherings and used digital platforms to stay updated with each other regularly and align the project.

02.3 External Communication at Dialog Axiata PLC

Dialog Axiata PLC uses various external communication channels to maintain transparency, consumer satisfaction, and stakeholder trust. Considering consumer communication channels, Dialog uses call centers, artificial intelligence-driven chatbots, SMS notifications, and Facebook, X (Twitter), and Instagram to offer timely announcements of new services. Online advertising campaigns of Dialog ensure that uniform messages of the company's brand remain consistent across various communication channels (Fernando & Perera, 2022). Regarding the communication of investor-relations, Dialog has been distributing information via online annual reports, press meetings, and on a regular basis updating its corporate web site with financial and governance related issues. This impression will support the idea that Dialog is transparent and accountable in its operations (Dialog Axiata PLC, 2023).

The regulatory communication channel is through both the formal correspondence and submission of compliance report to the Telecommunications Regulatory Commission of Sri Lanka (TRCSL) and consequently ensuring that the national policy and industry standards are adhered to (Jayawardena, 2021). Dialog also defines its environmental promise by making technical material less complicated and offering multilingual support that lowers communicative noise, which is outlined in Task 1. In addition, the digital campaigns that the company conducts with regard to eZ Cash demonstrate strong interactive communication systems, as clients interact by providing feedback on social media platforms, which leads to analytical data by informing service improvement and enhancing trust (Kumari & Wijesinghe, 2023).

02.4 Internal Stakeholder Analysis

Stakeholder Group	Communication Need	Preferred Channel	Challenges/Barriers
Senior Management	Strategic alignment	Leadership meetings, intranet	Information overload
Middle Managers	Coordination, performance reporting	Email, dashboards	Time constraints
Employees	Operational updates, motivation	Intranet, newsletters	Hierarchical barriers, mixed language proficiency

Table 1: Internal Stakeholder Analysis

In Dialog Axiata PLC, internal stakeholders interact under both formal and informal communication channels, and this way, they are able to collaborate and align with organizational targets. The top-level managers mainly share the direction of the strategy and the middle level managers change the strategy into operational targets in order to coordinate the teams. Workers who work at the implementation level require effective and encouraging communication to improve their performance and involvement.

Motivation-Hygiene Theory by Herzberg says that an open communication is a source of job satisfaction because it fulfills recognition and growth needs (Herzberg, 1966). Additionally, the interpersonal dimension of the SMCR model introduced by Berlo focuses on the fact that the success of the communication process is determined by the common understanding, attitudes, and empathy between the receiver and the sender (Muyanga and Phiri, 2021). When these factors are synchronized, communication will create a feeling of inclusion and trust hence enhancing motivation and productivity. As a result, it is important to maintain open feedback systems and culturally appropriate communication behaviors to strengthen the internal communication climate at Dialog.

02.5 External Stakeholder Analysis

Stakeholder Group	Communication Need	Preferred Channel	Challenges/Barriers
Customers	Service information, complaint handling	Social media, customer care	Technical jargon, delayed response
Regulators	Compliance data, policy updates	Official letters, reports	Bureaucratic delays
Investors	Performance transparency	Annual reports, press releases	Complex financial language
Community	CSR and sustainability	CSR reports, outreach events	Limited engagement

Table 2: External Stakeholder Analysis

Dialog Axiata PLC has a strong external communication with various stakeholders to achieve accountability, transparency, and trust. Digital platforms and call centres provide customers with real-time updates, and regulators with activities through official reporting so that the industry policies can be adhered to. The annual and sustainability reports inform investors about the performance of the corporate and its ethical conduct, whereas the community stakeholders are addressed with the help of corporate social responsibility (CSR) programs and outreach activities (Dialog Axiata PLC, 2023).

Using the feedback loop suggested by Shannon and Weaver, Dialog encourages a two-way communication approach, whereby the stakeholders get a chance to give their contribution in terms of surveys, complaint portals and social media interactions. Such an ongoing communication minimizes noise and builds stakeholder trust following responsiveness and clarity of message (Elhmaidi, 2023). Good feedback provides assurance that Dialog is able to send information and also to listen, adapt and build long-term relationships with its external audience.

02.6. Barriers to Effective Communication

Even though the communication system of Dialog Axiata PLC is extensive, there are various internal and external obstacles, which influence the clarity and efficiency of the message.

Hierarchy in communication inside the organization is known to slow down the process of making decisions because the messages are communicated through many levels of management. The diversity in language, Sinhala, Tamil, and English language is used in the operations, can lead to misunderstanding of instructions or company updates (Jayawardena, 2021). In addition, dependency on technology as in the use of intranet and digital communication systems may also interfere with the workflow in case of system interruptions. Even the regional branches may also have an effect on the reception of a message, which will affect teamwork and trust between employees (Fernando & Perera, 2022).

Outside, the misunderstanding of messages on social media, digital illiteracy in customers, and complicated regulating processes can misrepresent or slow the engagement of Dialog with the stakeholders. To manage the challenges the company has invested in employee communication training and language development program to improve interpersonal competence. Frequent feedback surveys and customer satisfaction monitoring assists them to establish gaps and enhance communication strategies. Digital technologies which include chatbots, automated reporting systems, and AI developed monitoring dashboards are also applied by Dialog to maintain messages consistency and timely delivery. Such proactive steps minimize the noise of the communication process which is in line with the focus on feedback and clarity of the Shannon-Weaver model which ultimately boosts organizational cohesion and trust by the stakeholders.

02.7 Conclusion

The stakeholder relationships of Dialog Axiata PLC are maintained through a highly centralized communication system that connects the happenings within the company to the perception of the people outside the company. The company does not simply adhere to a single means of communication since it utilizes a combination of formal and informal communication in order to include everyone in the loop and ensure actual collaboration. Dialog is ensuring that its messages are easy to understand, reduce the number of misconceptions, and even listen to feedback with the help of technical advice provided by the Shannon-Weaver and the SMCR models invented by Berlo. This strategy creates actual trust and interaction with employees, clients and regulators. It, also, helps Dialog remain elastic and receptive as the business and technology continue to evolve. This is not just a matter of communication being a tool of how Dialog works.

Task 03 Portfolio of Written Communication

03.1 Formal Business Email

Subject: Participation Request for Launch of the Employee Engagement Survey

Dear Department Heads,

I hope you receive this message well. In line with Dialog Axiata PLC's constant dedication to improving employee satisfaction and workplace culture, the Human Resources Department will be administering the Employee Engagement Survey 2025 from November 5 to November 15, 2025.

This survey aims to provide valuable feedback regarding employee motivation, communication effectiveness, and organizational climate. We are also asking you to assist us in urging all group members in your respective departments to fill in the survey. It will be anonymous, and the responses will be used to shape future HR activities and engagement practices.

Please note that the employees will be notified about the survey link that will be distributed through the internal portal on November 4th. We would be grateful for your assistance in attaining the highest possible participation.

In case of any doubts or any need for additional explanation, do not hesitate to address the undersigned directly. Thanks to your further cooperation and leadership towards a positive working environment.

Warm regards,

A S M Asfaq

Executive – Human Resources

Dialog Axiata PLC

03.2 Internal Memo

Date: 27 October 2025

To: All Employees

From: Manager Cooperate Conization

Subject: Implementation of New Digital Security Guidelines

Dear All Staff Members, we are pleased to inform you that new digital security procedures will be implemented beginning 01/11/21. The updated policy aims to improve privacy protection, secure the exchange of information, and ensure compliance with company policy and national ICT standards.

All staff must have completed the required Cybersecurity Awareness Module on the intranet by 10 November 2025. For more information, contact the IT Security Division.

03.3 Short Report

Introduction

This report is an overview of customer feedback for Dialog Axiata PLC's call-center performance in 3rd Quarter 2025.

Aim

To pinpoint core areas of service performance and list practical actions for prioritizing areas that need to be improved.

Findings

- Response Time: Two-thirds of clients were satisfied, and one out of five had to wait longer than expected.
- Service quality: 75% of the respondents appreciated the problem-solving skills of the call centre employees, although 18% complained that they received conflicting information from agents.
- Customer Experience: Some customers requested additional languages (Tamil and English) and service hours.

Recommendations

- Implement a call-prioritization system to manage peak-hour demand.
- Introduce standardized scripts and regular training to ensure message consistency.
- Expand multilingual support and extend service hours during high-traffic periods.
- Launch a customer satisfaction tracker to continuously measure service quality.

Conclusion

The analysis reveals that Dialog's call-center communication is strong but can be enhanced through targeted service training and better resource allocation. Continuous monitoring and structured feedback loops will reinforce Dialog's reputation for reliable and customer-centric communication.

03.4 Short Reflective Essay

Title: Reflection on the Application of Communication Models in Professional Practice

The knowledge of Shannon-Weaver and Berlo's SMCR communication models has greatly contributed to my perception of plant communication at Dialogue Axiata PLC. In the initial stages, I perceived communication as mainly transmission; my study on these models made me appreciate the importance of communication encoding, decoding, feedback, and the contribution of noise in marring meaning. This awareness has directed me to focus more on clarity, tone, and followership perception when writing dispatches or as a meeting chair.

Using the SMCR model by Berlo, I understood that communication success depends on the chops, station, and knowledge of the message's sender. Using simple and accessible language to communicate complex information, such as HR programs or design updates, has enhanced understanding and cooperation in the platoon. In addition, the participatory experience and empathy of Berlo have made me more aware of nonverbal communication and differences in art, particularly when I communicate with cross-departmental or multilingual brigades.

The Weaver and Shannon model also supported the worth of feedback circles. Implementing this in my communication practice, I started to look for evidence of understanding following meetings and written updates. This strategy minimized crimes, enhanced trust, and retained communication..

03.5 Conclusion

The four written materials indicate that I have communication competence regarding clarity, precision, and professionalism in different business scenarios. Both documents involve intentional writing, depending on the intended audience and purpose, communicating internal updates, summarizing analytical research or providing reflective knowledge. These instances are based on the communication theories like the model of Shannon-Weaver and the SMCR model of Berlo and demonstrate how theory applies in the practical world of communication in the workplace of Dialog Axiata PLC. The capability to code messages efficiently, promote feedback, and support its appropriate tone enhances teamwork in the organization, leadership communication, and stakeholder relations, which are among the primary factors of successful business performance and corporate integrity.